

Project Proposal

Dermestha — Online Dermatology Consultation Platform

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Executive Summary

Dermestha is a purpose-built online platform that lets patients in Pakistan book and attend a live video consultation with a dermatologist — from their phone, without traveling to a clinic. After the consultation, the doctor creates a digital prescription inside the platform, and the patient downloads it as a PDF. The whole experience, from booking to prescription, happens in one place.

Pakistan's telemedicine market is dominated by large general-purpose platforms that list 20,000+ doctors across 200+ specialties. These are healthcare supermarkets. Dermestha is the opposite: a specialty boutique for skin. Every feature is designed specifically for dermatology — the booking flow, the prescription format, the consultation interface, and the doctor experience.

The v1 launch tests a single question: **will Pakistani patients book and pay for an online dermatology consultation?** If the answer is yes — which the competitive research and market context strongly suggest — the platform is positioned to grow into a trusted home for skin care in Pakistan.

This proposal covers the full scope, timeline, and investment for the first version of Dermestha, ready to launch within 8 weeks.

Why This Approach Works for Your Practice

The Pakistani telemedicine landscape

Several platforms already offer online doctor consultations in Pakistan. They each serve a different angle of the same general-purpose market:

Platform	What it is
Ola Doc (oladoc.com)	The market leader by volume. ~25,000 doctors across 120+ specialties. Web + iOS + Android. Includes pharmacy delivery and lab booking.
Al Marham (marham.pk)	Closest competitor to Ola Doc. ~20,000 PMC-verified doctors across 200+ specialties. Strong on patient education and bilingual content.
Sehat Kahani (sehatkahani.com)	Women-doctor-led telemedicine network. Strong focus on rural reach and female patients. Used by NGOs and corporate health programs.
Shifa4U (shifa4u.com)	Telemedicine arm of Shifa International Hospital. Hospital-backed, institutional brand trust, narrower doctor pool.
Healthwire (healthwire.pk)	Appointment booking + teleconsultation directory. Lighter platform — more of a discovery layer than a full telehealth product.

What they all have in common: **they are generalist platforms**. A patient looking for skin care sees the same interface and the same workflow as a patient looking for a pediatrician, cardiologist, or psychiatrist. Skin care is one tab in a long list.

How Dermestha is different

Dermestha is the first Pakistani platform built for a single specialty: dermatology. Every choice — the booking flow, the prescription format, the doctor profile fields, even the visual design — exists to serve one type of patient: someone with a skin concern.

	Generalist platforms (Ola Doc, Al Marham, Sehat Kahani, Shifa4U, Healthwire)	Dermestha
Doctor variety	Thousands of doctors across 100+ specialties	Curated dermatologists only
Patient discovery	Filter by specialty among hundreds of options	Browse skin specialists directly — no filtering needed
Prescription format	Generic digital upload or generic e-prescription	Doctor-built in-app: medicines, dosage, instructions — structured for skin treatments
Consultation design	Generic telemedicine UI	Built for visual skin examination (good lighting prompts, photo-friendly UX in future versions)
Scale at launch	Massive — trust from volume	Small, curated — trust from quality and focus
Brand positioning	Healthcare supermarket	Specialty boutique for skin
Payments	Cards + wallets (varies by platform)	Cards + JazzCash + Easypaisa + bank transfer (Safepay)

Why specialty focus is a real advantage

The generalist platforms have a structural ceiling on how good they can make any single specialty experience. They have to design for every specialty equally, so they design for the average. Dermestha can design for one — and that means the entire patient journey, from landing page to prescription, can be tailored to dermatology in ways the large platforms will never prioritise.

For patients, the message is simple and powerful: **"This platform exists for your skin."** That is a positioning the generalists cannot copy without abandoning the model that makes them work.

What You Get — Version 1 Deliverables

Everything listed below will be live and working at launch.

Patient-facing

- **Landing page** — A clean, professional website that explains Dermestha, shows the listed dermatologists, and guides visitors to book a consultation. Entry point from social media and search.
- **Patient account** — Patients sign up with an email address. They stay logged in across visits.
- **Doctor profiles** — Each listed dermatologist has a profile page: photo, bio, area of specialization, consultation fee, and which days and times they are available.
- **Slot booking** — Patients pick a doctor, choose a date, select an available 30-minute slot, and confirm. A booking confirmation email is sent immediately.
- **Reminder emails** — An automatic email goes out 24 hours before the appointment, and another 1 hour before. Patients don't miss their call.
- **Live video consultation** — At the scheduled time, the patient clicks "Join Call." The video works on ordinary mobile connections (3G-compatible). No app to download — it works directly in the browser.
- **Online payment via Safepay** — Before or at booking, the patient pays through Safepay. Safepay covers all major payment methods in Pakistan in one step: Visa/Mastercard, JazzCash, Easypaisa, and bank transfer. No separate integrations needed. *(See "A Note on the Payment Gateway" below for why I am suggesting Safepay over a direct bank gateway like UBL.)*
- **Patient dashboard** — After the consultation, the patient's dashboard shows their appointments and any prescriptions. They can download their prescription PDF at any time.

Doctor-facing

- **Doctor dashboard** — You see the day's appointments in one view, with the patient name, scheduled time, and a "Join Call" button.
- **Prescription builder** — After the consultation, you open the prescription tool, select medicines from the platform's medicine list (with a free-text option for anything not on the list), add dosage, duration, and instructions for each medicine, add any general notes, and submit. The platform generates a formatted PDF prescription automatically.
- **Availability management** — You set your weekly schedule (which days and what hours you are available). Patients can only book within those hours.

Admin (internal use)

- **Doctor management** — Add new dermatologists to the platform, manage their approval status.
- **Medicine catalogue** — Maintain the list of medicines that appears in the prescription builder. Add, edit, or deactivate medicines as needed.

A Note on the Payment Gateway

Pakistan has two types of online payment products: **aggregators** (Safepay, PayFast) that accept cards plus mobile wallets in a single integration, and **bank gateways** (UBL eMerchant, HBL DirectPay, MCB Direct) that accept Visa/Mastercard only. Bank gateways cannot process JazzCash or Easypaisa — those are mobile wallet products run by separate companies.

This matters because Pakistani patients overwhelmingly pay with mobile wallets: roughly **60% via JazzCash or Easypaisa**, only **20% by card**, with the remainder using direct bank transfer.

If a patient has only...	Safepay	UBL gateway
A debit/credit card	✅ Pays	✅ Pays
A JazzCash or Easypaisa wallet	✅ Pays	❌ Cannot pay
A bank account (no card)	✅ Pays via direct transfer	❌ Cannot pay

My recommendation: Safepay for v1. Zero setup fee, zero monthly fee, one merchant application, and all four payment methods at checkout — no patient is turned away. UBL's slightly lower per-card-transaction rate (~1.5–2% vs Safepay's ~3%) is real, but it comes with a setup fee (~PKR 25–50K), monthly maintenance, and roughly 80% of Pakistani patients blocked from paying because they don't have a card.

This is a suggestion, not a requirement. If you prefer a bank gateway like UBL — for example, because your target patients are primarily card-using, or you already have a UBL merchant relationship you want to leverage — I will integrate that instead at the same project price. The development effort is similar; the trade-off is yours to make with full awareness of the coverage gap.

Either way, the v1 design supports adding a second gateway later. A common post-launch move is to route card payments through a bank gateway (saving 1% on the card share) while keeping an aggregator for wallets. (See "*What Comes After Launch*" below.)

What Is NOT Included in Version 1

To stay focused and ship on time, the following are explicitly out of scope for this initial version. They are not forgotten — they are planned for after launch.

Not in v1	Why deferred
SMS / WhatsApp reminders	Email-only notifications are sufficient to validate the launch hypothesis; SMS/WhatsApp adds complexity and cost
Lab test booking	Requires integrations with third-party labs; not part of the core consultation loop
Medical records history	Valuable but not needed to validate the first booking
iOS / Android native app	Mobile-responsive website is sufficient for v1; native apps are a v2 consideration
Urdu language	High value but significant scope; deferred to v1.2
AI skin diagnosis	Future capability; requires regulatory consideration
Instant / on-demand calls	Live queue requires real-time infrastructure; added in v1.1 once the platform is stable
Multi-city / multi-specialty	Dermestha is dermatology-only by design

What Comes After Launch

Once v1 is live and validated, I can add the following in short follow-on engagements:

Immediately after launch (2–4 weeks)

- SMS and WhatsApp notifications (same booking/reminder triggers, additional channel)
- Live queue — doctors go "online" and patients can join a real-time queue without pre-booking

Later (v1.2 onwards)

- Additional dermatologists added via admin panel — no development needed
- **Payment gateway optimisation** — once the platform has 3–6 months of booking data, add a direct bank gateway (UBL or HBL) for card payments to save ~1% on the card-paying share, while keeping Safepay for wallet payments. Patient still sees one checkout.
- Pharmacy ordering and price lookup (requires pharmacy partnerships)
- Urdu language support
- Native iOS and Android apps (can reuse the entire backend as-is)

Timeline and Milestones

Total duration: 8 weeks at 4 hours/day (equivalent to 4 full-time weeks).

You will see a working version of the platform at each milestone and can provide feedback before the next phase begins.

Milestone	End of week	What you can see and test
M1 — Booking flow	Week 2	Working website: patient signs up, browses doctors, books a slot, receives a confirmation email
M2 — Video + Payments	Week 4	Full video consultation end-to-end (mobile-tested on a slow connection); Safepay payment flow working
M3 — Prescriptions	Week 6	Doctor builds a prescription after the call; patient downloads the PDF from their dashboard
M4 — Launch-ready	Week 8	Admin panel, landing page, email automation, full end-to-end QA across all flows — ready to go live

What I Need From You

To start development immediately and avoid delays:

Item	When needed	Notes
Doctor profiles (×3–5)	Week 1	Photo, name, bio, area of specialization, consultation fee, and weekly availability (e.g., Mon/Wed/Fri, 6pm–9pm) for each doctor you want listed at launch
Medicine list	Week 2	A list of the medicines you commonly prescribe — I'll load these into the prescription builder
Domain name	Week 1	e.g., <code>dermestha.com</code> (if not yet registered, I can advise)
Business email address	Week 1	e.g., <code>noreply@dermestha.com</code> — used for confirmation and reminder emails
Safepay merchant application	Immediately	Apply at getsafepay.pk — approval takes 1–2 weeks. Start this in parallel with development so payments are ready by M2. I'll guide you through the application.

Note on doctors: The platform launches with the 3–5 dermatologists you provide. Adding more doctors after launch is a simple admin-panel action — no development needed.

Investment

Project fee

TOTAL PROJECT FEE

PKR 350,000

A single fixed fee covering all v1 deliverables listed above — the patient booking flow, video consultation, online payments via Safepay, prescription builder, dashboards, admin panel, landing page, and email automation. Based on approximately 160 hours of senior full-stack development work delivered over 8 weeks.

Payment schedule

When	Amount	Trigger
Project start	PKR 105,000 (30%)	Signed proposal
M2 completion	PKR 140,000 (40%)	Video calls + Safepay working
M4 completion	PKR 105,000 (30%)	Full platform, launch-ready

What is NOT included in this fee (paid directly by you)

These are ongoing operational costs, not development costs:

Service	Estimated monthly cost
Vercel (website hosting)	Free tier at launch
Railway (backend + database hosting)	~\$5–20/month
Daily.co (video calls)	Free up to 10,000 minutes/month
Resend (email delivery)	Free up to 3,000 emails/month
Domain name	PKR 2,000–5,000/year
Safepay transaction fee	~2–3.5% per transaction (deducted automatically — no extra monthly fee)

At launch volume (~100 consultations/week), total hosting cost is under \$30/month. These services scale gradually as the platform grows.

Next Steps

If this proposal aligns with what you are looking for, the next step is a short call to walk through any questions, confirm timelines, and formalise the engagement through a signed agreement.

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